BEHIND THE BUILD · PROJECT MANAGEMENT · 7 OF 8

Stakeholder Communications

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

These two communications are an organizational-context simulation. The portfolio build was solo, with no stakeholders to update and no design review to convene, so both samples are fictional. Both are written in the voice of the L&D-Manager role this work targets and grounded in the project's actual deliverables, decisions, and constraints. They show how the program would be managed and communicated inside an organization, and each carries a short note on why it is built the way it is. This is one way the communication could look; the cadence, format, and tone would vary significantly with an organization's structure and cultural norms.

SAMPLE 1 · STATUS UPDATE (SIMULATED)

Weekly Project Status Update

TO Executive Sponsor, HR Business Partner, IT Platform Lead

FROM L&D Program Manager

DATE Week of May 5, 2026

RE AI Literacy Program: Status Update (Week 6 of 8)

Workstream	Status	Notes
Content Development	● Complete	All four modules authored, reviewed, and integrated. 37 sections, 16 knowledge checks, 3 interpretation checks finalized.
Platform Build	● Complete	Custom React platform deployed to Cloudflare Pages. 12 interactive components, admin dashboard, three-mode navigation, dark mode. Production code cleanup complete.
Assessment System	● Complete	12-item pre/post assessment (parallel design) implemented and integrated into the admin-dashboard analytics.
Evaluation Framework	● In Progress	Levels 1 and 2 design documents complete. Level 3 (behavioral) in final review. Level 4 (ROI) drafting this week. Target: complete by May 16.
PM Documentation	● Not Started	Deferred until the evaluation framework is complete. Retrospective, no upstream dependency. Target: May 19.

Progress since last update

The platform build reached production quality this week. The three-mode navigation system (learner, portfolio, admin) is deployed and tested. Learner mode enforces sequential progression; portfolio mode enables free navigation for hiring reviewers and internal stakeholders; admin mode exposes the full analytics dashboard with live data. The citation-visibility toggle, which lets readers show or hide inline source references, passed smoke testing across all 41 platform routes with zero errors.

Risks and mitigations

Articulate build (Component 5) remains deferred. No budget for Rise/Storyline licensing. Mitigation: the custom platform serves as the primary portfolio artifact and is fully functional. The Articulate build would demonstrate authoring-tool proficiency but is not required for program completeness. Recommendation: defer indefinitely and reallocate effort to the evaluation framework, which carries stronger signal for management-level roles.

Evaluation-framework timeline is tight. Four design documents (6A–6D) in 10 days. Mitigation: the framework structure is well-defined and all upstream content (performance objectives, action-map behaviors, assessment instruments) is finalized. No blocking dependencies remain.

Decisions needed

None this week. The remaining work is execution against approved designs.

Next update: week of May 12.

COMMUNICATION DESIGN

The status update leads with a status table so a reader can assess overall health in about ten seconds; the narrative sections are read only when the table raises a question. The "Decisions needed" section appears even when empty; its absence would leave a reader wondering whether they had missed something. The memo also reflects the build's three-mode design at the time; the platform later consolidated to two modes (learner/portfolio).

SAMPLE 2 · DESIGN REVIEW (SIMULATED)

Phase 2 Design Review: Decisions and Action Items

TO Design Review Attendees (ID, FS, SME, ES)
FROM L&D Program Manager
DATE April 21, 2026
RE Phase 2 Design Review: Decisions and Action Items

This summarizes the outcomes from the Phase 2 design review conducted on April 18. The review covered the program structure (Component 3A), the component specifications (4A–4E), the design system (Component 5), and the data-validation protocol. Five items were raised; dispositions follow.

1 ● Implemented — Owner · Instructional Designer

RAISED **Module 3 scope: steerability should be a standalone section, not folded into the “properties” section.**

DECISION Accepted. Module 3 expanded from 10 to 11 sections. Steerability and synthesis (“When Properties Meet”) are now separate sections.

2 ● Revised — Owner · L&D Manager

RAISED **Pre/post assessment: 10 items may be too few for reliable measurement across four competency dimensions.**

DECISION Retained at 10 items at this review, as a tradeoff between construct coverage and completion burden for time-pressured mid-career professionals (6B §7.5). Later reversed: expanded to 12 items, because the 10-item form had no pre/post pair for task decomposition (Delegation) or disclosure (Diligence).

3 ● Resolved — Owner · L&D Manager

RAISED **The platform should collect Level 1 survey data directly to simplify evaluation.**

DECISION Declined. The platform collects no PII by design: no server-side store, no data-governance infrastructure. The survey is administered externally. Rationale in 6A §2.

4 ● Deferred — Owner · Full-Stack Developer

RAISED **Data dashboards should use live API data rather than static JSON files.**

DECISION Deferred. Static JSON with validated provenance is appropriate for a portfolio piece; live API integration is an enhancement for organizational deployment where real-time feeds exist.

5 ● Resolved — Owner · Instructional Designer

RAISED **Module 4 runs 70–105 minutes, over its original 20–30 minute target, the longest of the four modules.**

DECISION Accepted at the measured length. Module 4 is the program's capstone and carries five of the twelve practice activities (P8–P12). Module 1 tells learners to plan more than one sitting for most modules and to stop after a practice activity or a knowledge check.

Summary

Three items were resolved with no design change required: items 2, 3, and 5, each a deliberate design decision with documented rationale. One item was accepted and implemented: item 1, the Module 3 scope expansion. One item was deferred to organizational deployment: item 4, live API data. No items were escalated to the Executive Sponsor.

The review confirms that the Phase 2 architecture is approved for content development and platform build. Phase 3 begins April 25.

Action-items tracker updated. Next design review: post-build QA review, tentatively May 12.

COMMUNICATION DESIGN

The design-review summary leads with a decision table: stakeholders need to know what was decided and who owns the action, not what was discussed. Each row carries a disposition (Implemented, Resolved, Deferred) and an owner, and the format scales: a fifteen-item review uses the same structure.

© Michael Ritchot. Code licensed under the MIT License. Instructional content licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.